



Psychology of Motivation

AH 1104

Lecture 2

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BA (Hons.) Psychology

Contents

- Defining Motivation
- Theories of Motivation
- Motivating changes in behaviour

Objectives

- Understand concepts and different theories of motivation
- Assess types of human motivations and apply into health settings

References

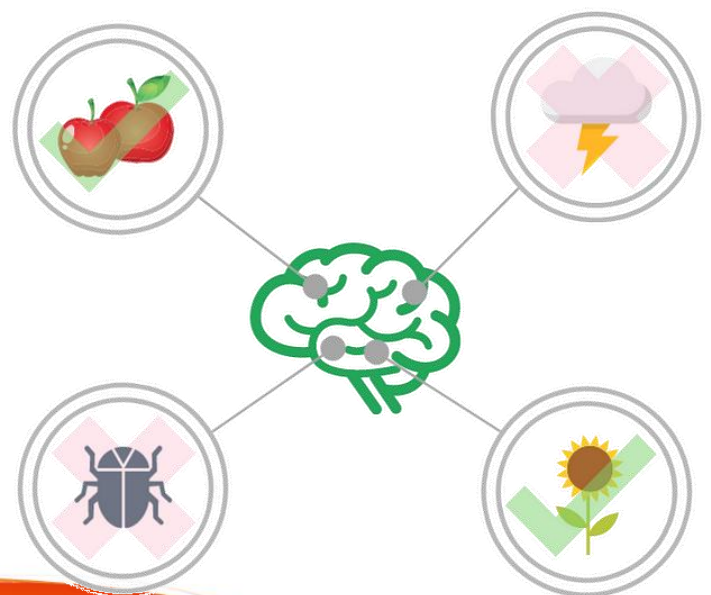
- Feldman, R. S. (2012). Psychology and Your Life. New York: Tata McGraw Hill Companies
- Crashcourse (2014). The Power of Motivation #17
- Crashcourse (2014). Let's talk about sex #27

What is Motivation?

- Factors that account for the **initiation**, **direction**, **intensity**, and **persistence** of behavior.
- **Drives:**
 - *Primary/ unlearned* (hunger, thirst, sleep, sex)
 - *Secondary/ learned* (goals, desires, interests, power, curiosity)

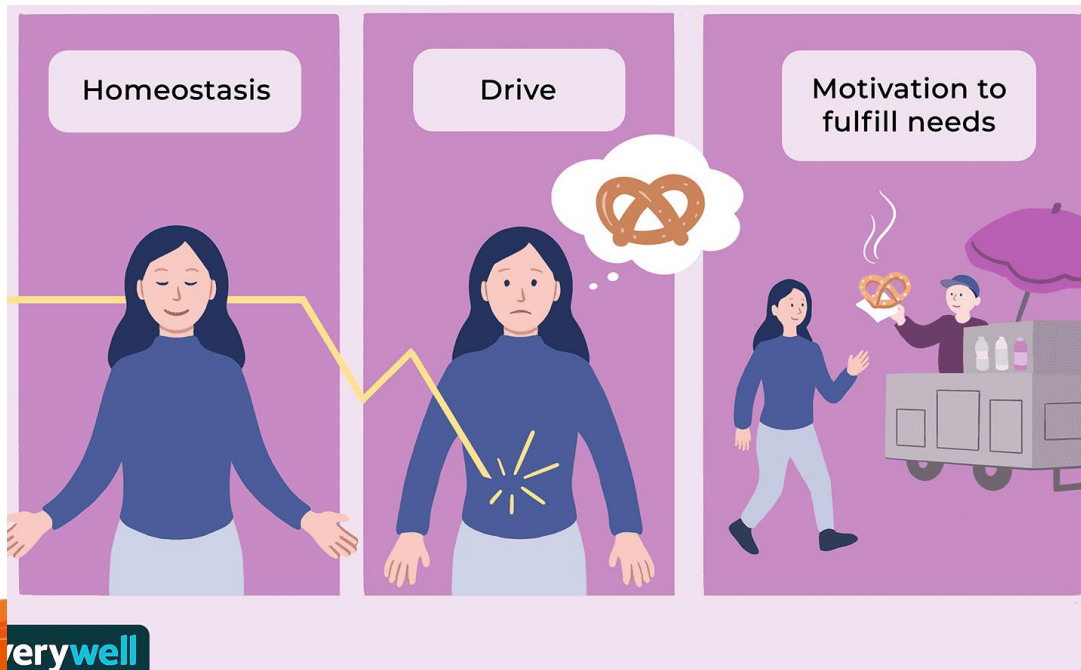
1) Instinct Theory

- Certain behaviors are **innate** or **hard-wired** into individuals
- Motivation of hunger
- Sexual motivation



2) Drive-reduction Theory (Hull, 1943)

➤ Drive = motivational tension that we try to reduce



3) Motivation of Hunger and Eating

Why do we feel hungry?

1. What are biological factors associated with regulation of hunger?
2. Are there psychological and social factors regulating hunger?
3. What are some maladaptive eating behaviours?

Eating Disorders

1) Anorexia Nervosa



Signs of Anorexia in Teens

A woman with long brown hair, wearing a pink long-sleeved shirt and blue pants, is measuring her waist with a yellow tape measure. She has a serious expression.

Not maintaining healthy weight

Extreme fear of weight gain

Continuous dieting

Excessive and compulsive exercising

Being obsessed with diets, calories, etc.

Very restricting of what they eat

Avoiding food or denying hunger

Developing rituals regarding food

verywell

Eating Disorders

3) Bulimia Nervosa

Common Symptoms of Bulimia

A man with dark skin, wearing an orange shirt, is sitting at a table eating a large meal consisting of a burger, fries, and a drink. A clock on the wall shows it's late in the day.

Eating a significant amount of food in a limited time (binging)

A man with dark skin, wearing an orange shirt, is sitting at a table looking distressed at a plate of food. A clock on the wall shows it's late in the day.

Experiencing feelings of guilt, shame, or anxiety after eating

A man with dark skin, wearing a brown shirt and blue shorts, is looking at his reflection in a mirror. He has a concerned expression.

Preoccupation with body weight or shape

A man with dark skin, wearing an orange shirt and blue pants, is leaning over a toilet, appearing to be purging. Green lines above his head indicate nausea or distress.

Purging food from the body after eating

A bottle of diet pills or diuretics with a green and white label, with several white pills spilled next to it.

Use of diet pills or diuretics to control weight

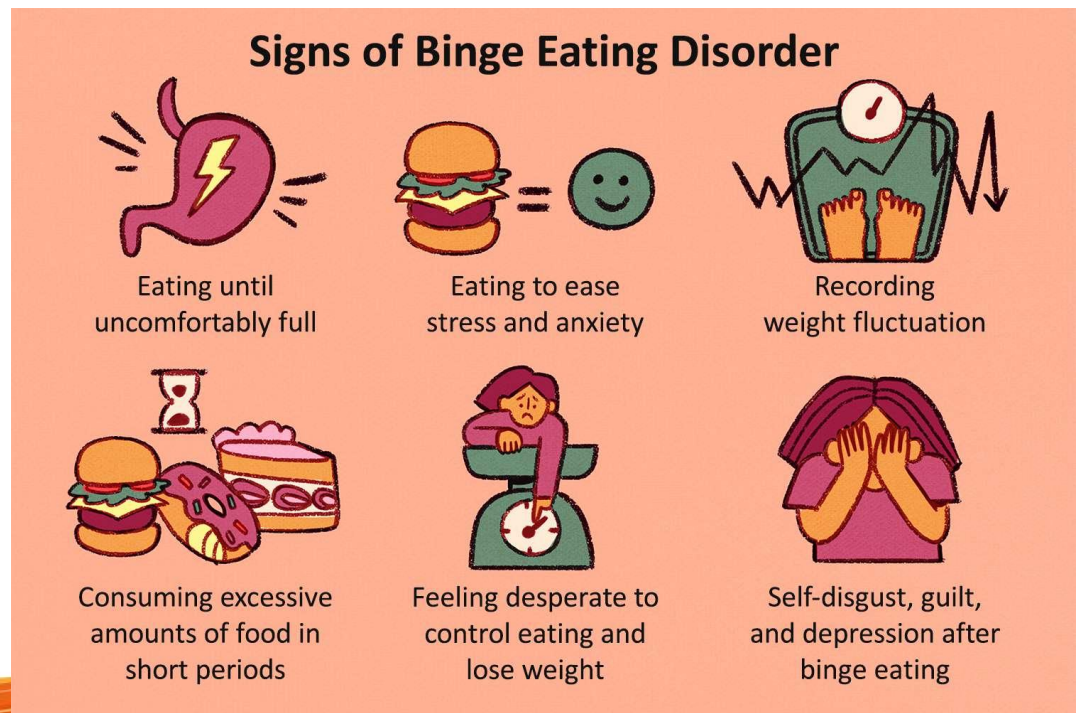
A man with dark skin, wearing an orange shirt and blue shorts, is running on a treadmill. He is sweating and looking determined.

Excessive exercise to prevent weight gain

verywell

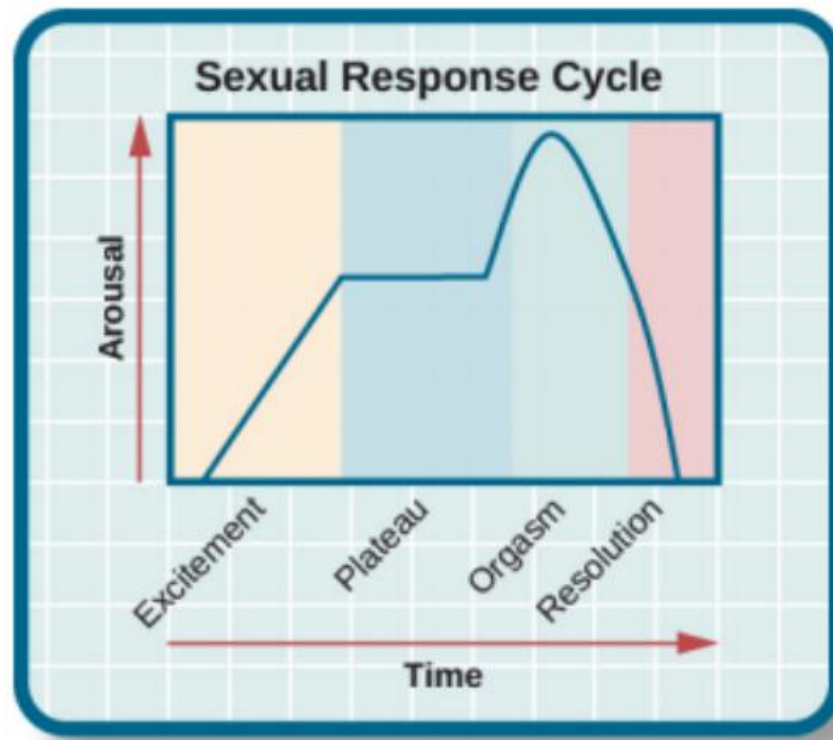
Eating Disorders

2) Binge eating



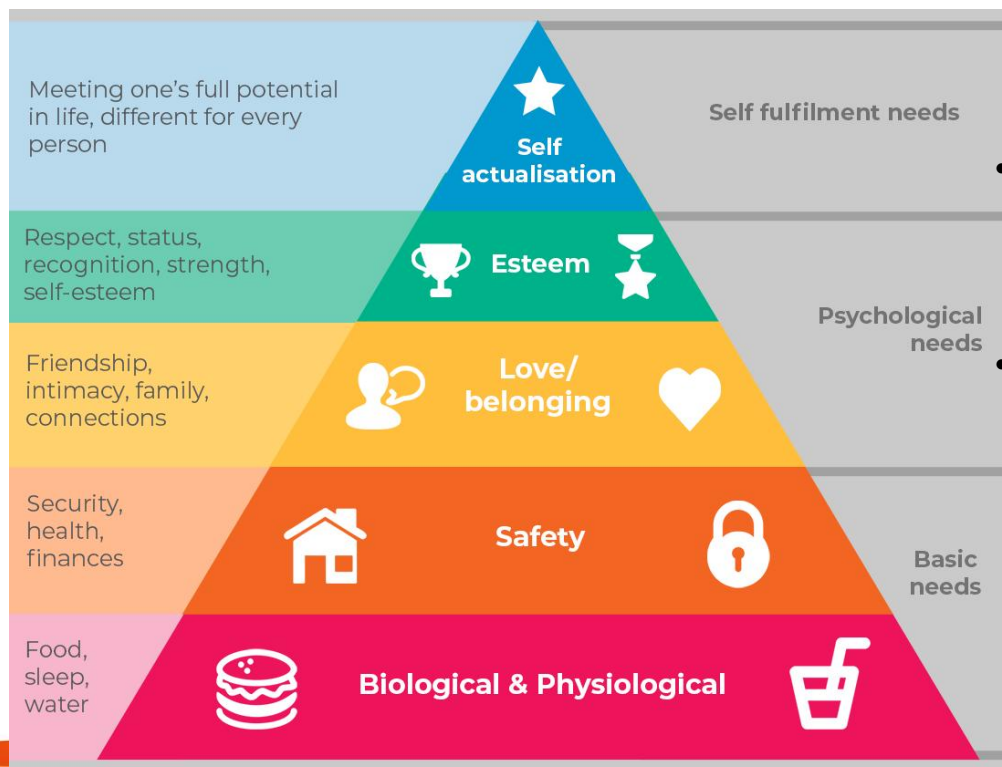
4) Sexual Motivation

- The natural and instinctive urge to engage in sexual activity.
- Not necessarily homeostatic
- Evolution - Supports the survival of the species
- Factors influencing sexual motivation?



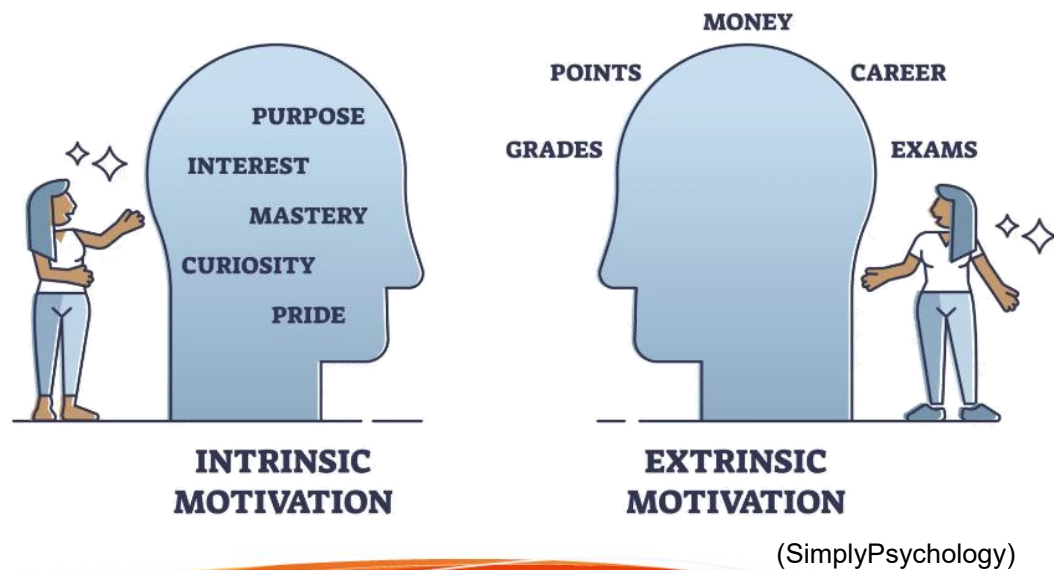
Zarrinmehr, 2023 (Study.com)

5) The Hierarchy of Needs - Abraham Maslow (1987)

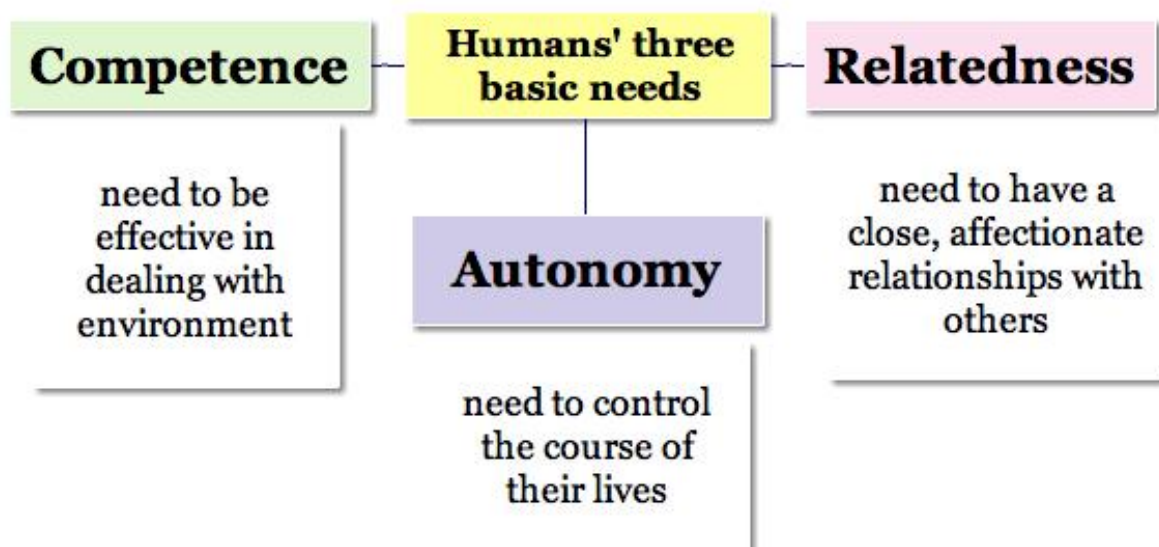


- Individuals work upwards through the pyramid to fulfil needs (Maslow, 1987)
- Multiple motivational Theories can be applied for a broader understanding

6) Intrinsic and Extrinsic Motivation



7) Self-Determination Theory (SDT) - (Ryan & Deci, 1980s)



8) The Health Belief Model (HBM)

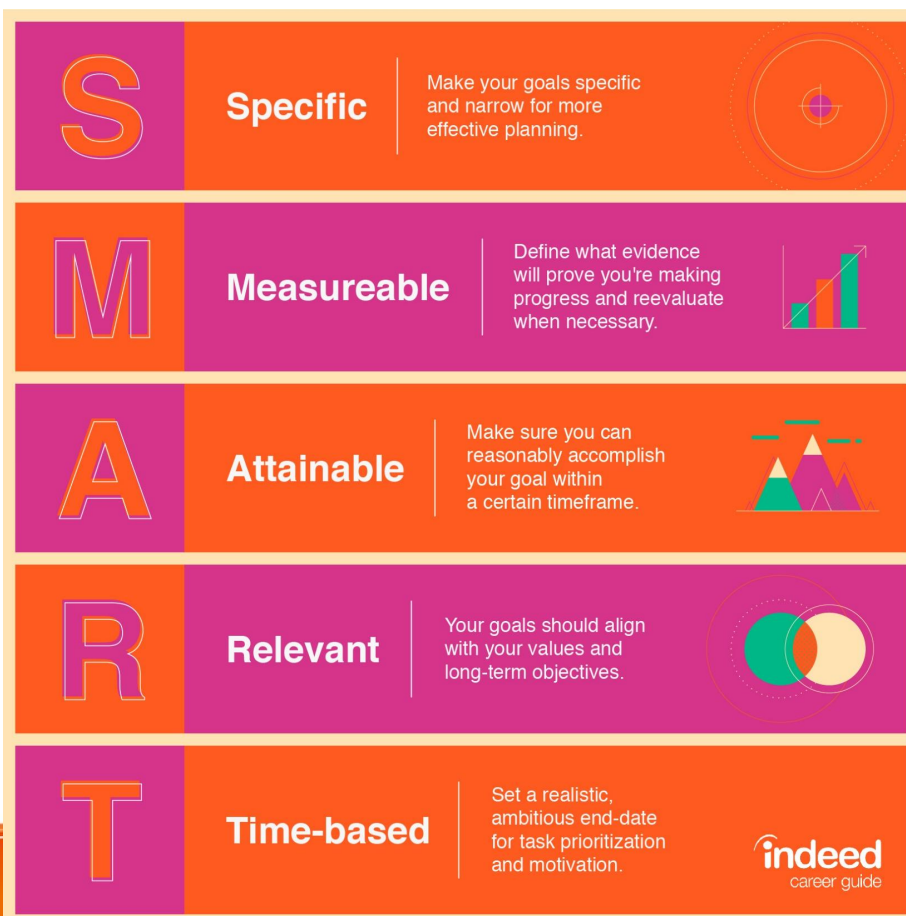
- A psychological model that attempts to **explain** and **predict** health behaviors by focusing on the **attitudes** and **beliefs** of individuals:
 - **Perceived Susceptibility**: One's belief that there's a high chance of getting a condition.
 - **Perceived Severity**: One's opinion on how serious the condition and its consequences are.
 - **Perceived Benefits**: Belief in the effectiveness of the treatment.
 - **Perceived Barriers**: Low costs/disadvantages of the treatment.
 - **Cues to Action**: Strategies or events that activate readiness to act (e.g., a symptom, a reminder).
 - **Self-Efficacy**: Confidence in one's ability to successfully perform the action.

9) 'Self efficacy' and 'Locus of Control'

- **Self-efficacy** : A person's belief in their ability to perform a task
- **Locus of control** :
 - Internal Locus (they believe they can influence their health)
 - External Locus (they believe health is down to fate or the doctor).

How can we motivate change in behaviour?

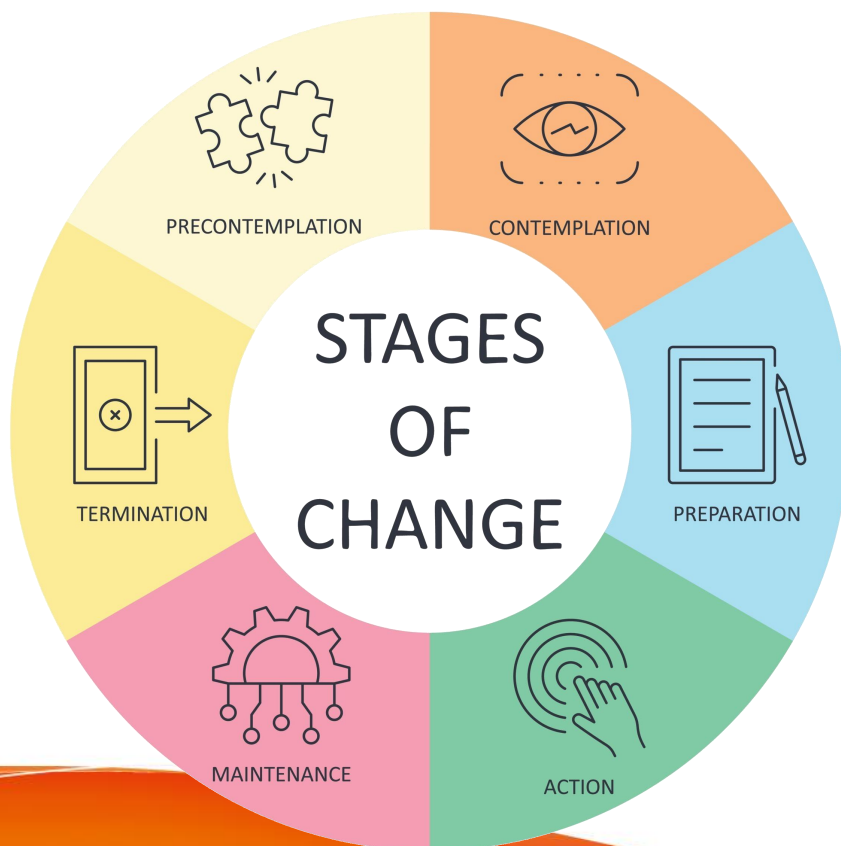
➤ SMART Goal Setting



How can we motivate change in behaviour?

➤ Stages of Change Model

- Motivational Interviewing



Let's test it!

➤ Case Study Analysis:

- A patient refusing a painful but necessary X-ray.
- A patient not making any progress in stroke recovery exercises.
- A patient with diabetes refusing to change their diet.

**What factors might be impacting their lack of motivation?
What can be done to help them?**

